ISSUE
No
XIII

📅 SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

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ISSUE
No
XIII

📅 SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

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> No. I can survive well enough on my own— if given the proper reading material.
>
> -SARAH J. MAAS

STAY INFORMED.
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THE HINDU • SOCIAL JUSTICE & CONSTITUTIONAL RIGHTS

Orthodoxy redux: On Keralam, religion and Muslim women's rights

Religious orthodox decrees must not curtail women's constitutional rights and public participation in progressive Kerala.

September 3, 2026 • 2 min read • DAILY EDITORIAL READER

Veteran Islamic cleric Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar's **directive**[3] to restrict Muslim women's participation in public celebrations has unsettled Keralam because it **strikes at**[4] a fundamental question: women's right to participate in public life. This is not merely a quarrel over how Muslims should mark Prophet Muhammad's 1,501st birth anniversary. It is a test of how far religious authority can **intrude into**[5] the lives of women in a State that takes pride in its progressive social history. Kanthapuram says he is merely reminding followers of established religious norms. His supporters argue Milad celebrations have moved beyond mosques and madrasas into large public events, and that scholars have a duty to **caution against**[6] such **departures**[7]. That argument **holds no weight**[8]. Communities have the right to preserve traditions and regulate religious practices, but they have to **conform to**[9] the values **enshrined in**[10] the Constitution. When women are told to remain at home because their presence could cause "chaos", the issue is no longer about religious observance; it is **at variance with**[11] constitutional equality and Keralam's long struggle to expand the space in public life for women disadvantaged by social customs and religious traditions.

The Muslim community is not a **monolith**[12]. It contains both orthodox and progressive currents. More Muslim women are breaking barriers in education, employment, politics and public life, but that progress is encountering a **counter-current**[13] of renewed **orthodoxy**[1] and social control. The CPI(M), Keralam's main Opposition party and a decades-old ally of the Kanthapuram-led faction of Samastha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama, a body of Sunni scholars, has responded sharply. The Congress, which leads the ruling coalition, was largely **guarded**[14] until Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan **rubbished**[15] the decree as **antediluvian**[16]. The Indian Union Muslim League's silence is harder to defend. A party with an active women's forum and a woman legislator for the first time in the State Assembly cannot **equivocate**[17] when women's right to public participation is **open to challenge**[18]. Its caution may reflect political pressure over Waqf, Vande Mataram and PM-SHRI, or an attempt to improve ties with the Kanthapuram faction amid **strained**[19] relations with the rival Samastha faction. Whatever the political calculation, silence carries a cost. Religious freedom does not **confer on**[20] religious authorities the right to regulate women's freedom of movement, association and degree of participation in society. During Onam, social media were **awash with**[21] videos of young Muslim girls celebrating the harvest festival. Kanthapuram's remarks drew criticism from a section of Muslim women on social media. Keralam cannot claim to be progressive while making exceptions for **orthodoxy**[1].

Source: The Hindu
Published: September 03, 2026 12:20 AM IST

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **Orthodoxy** (Noun) Traditionalism • रूढ़िवादिता / कट्टरता
2. **redux** (Adjective) Revived • पुनरुत्थान / दोबारा लौटा हुआ
3. **directive** (Noun) Official order • निर्देश / शासनादेश
4. **strikes at** (Verb) Attacks directly • सीधा प्रहार करना / मूल पर चोट करना
5. **intrude into** (Verb) Interfere unwantedly • अनधिकार प्रवेश करना / दखल देना
6. **caution against** (Verb) Warn about • आगाह करना / सचेत करना
7. **departures** (Noun) Deviations • विचलन / स्थापित नियमों से भटकाव
8. **holds no weight** (Phrase) Has no value • महत्वहीन होना / कोई दम न होना
9. **conform to** (Verb) Abide by • के अनुरूप होना / पालन करना
10. **enshrined in** (Adjective) Protected in • प्रतिष्ठापित / समाहित होना
11. **at variance with** (Prepositional phrase) In conflict with • से भिन्न या असहमत / के विपरीत
12. **monolith** (Noun) Single uniform block • अखंड विशाल इकाई / एकाश्म
13. **counter-current** (Noun) Opposing trend • विपरीत धारा / विरोधी प्रवृत्ति
14. **guarded** (Adjective) Cautious • सतर्क / नपा-तुला
15. **rubbished** (Verb) Rejected completely • खारिज कर दिया / बकवास बताकर नकारा
16. **antediluvian** (Adjective) Extremely outdated • अति प्राचीन / दकियानूसी
17. **equivocate** (Verb) Speak unclearly • गोलमोल बात करना / टालमटोल करना
18. **open to challenge** (Phrase) Vulnerable to dispute • चुनौती के दायरे में / विवाद योग्य
19. **strained** (Adjective) Tense • तनावपूर्ण / असहज
20. **confer on** (Verb) Grant to • प्रदान करना / प्रदान किया जाना
21. **awash with** (Adjective) Flooded with • से भरा हुआ / लबालब

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Orthodoxy redux: On Keralam, religion and Muslim women's rights
THE HINDU • SOCIAL JUSTICE & CONSTITUTIONAL RIGHTS

EDITORIAL STANCE
CRITICAL
"strongly disapproving regressive curbs"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author strongly censures orthodox religious decrees that seek to restrict Muslim women from participating in public celebrations. Emphasising that religious autonomy cannot override fundamental constitutional equality, the editorial highlights Kerala's progressive heritage and rebukes political parties for their opportunistic silence or equivocation.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY 8 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Orthodoxy** NOUN NEGATIVE	रूढ़िवादिता / कट्टरता Strict adherence to traditional, established, or conventional religious beliefs and practices.	Orthodox beliefs are 'rigid like an orthodontist's braces'—strictly bound to old rules.	· dogmatism · traditionalism · conservatism	· heterodoxy · progressivism · unconventionality
02	**directive** NOUN NEUTRAL	निर्देश / शासनादेश An official instruction or authoritative order issued by a leader or body.	A directive gives you a specific 'direction' or command to follow.	· instruction · mandate · edict	· request · plea · recommendation
03	**departures** NOUN NEUTRAL	विचलन / स्थापित नियमों से भटकाव Actions that deviate from established norms, rules, or traditional ways of doing things.	Departing from the routine road means deviating from normal practice.	· deviations · divergences · variations	· conformities · adherences · continuations
04	**counter-current** NOUN NEGATIVE	विपरीत धारा / विरोधी प्रवृत्ति A tendency, force, or movement running contrary to the prevailing trend.	Swimming 'counter' (against) the main 'current'.	· backlash · reaction · counter-trend	· mainstream · concurrence · reinforcement
05	**guarded** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	सतर्क / नपा-तुला Cautious and reserved in showing one's true feelings or opinions.	A person keeping their guard up speaks very carefully.	· circumspect · reticent · cautious	· frank · candid · outspoken
06	**rubbished** VERB NEGATIVE	खारिज कर दिया / बकवास बताकर नकारा Severely criticised, mocked, or dismissed as worthless and absurd.	Treating someone's idea like 'rubbish' (trash) and tossing it away.	· dismissed · derided · scorned	· praised · endorsed · applauded
07	**equivocate** VERB NEGATIVE	गोलमोल बात करना / टालमटोल करना To use ambiguous or evasive language deliberately to conceal the truth or avoid committing.	'Equi' (equal) + 'voice' = speaking in two equal, ambiguous voices to evade commitment.	· prevaricate · hedge · vacillate	· clarify · be forthright · articulate clearly
08	**strained** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	तनावपूर्ण / असहज Marked by tension, uneasy relations, and lack of cordiality.	A rope under high tension is 'strained' and close to breaking.	· fraught · tense · uneasy	· cordial · harmonious · amicable

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • ORTHODOXY REDUX: ON KERALAM, RELIGION AND MUSLIM WOMEN'S RIGHTS

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**monolith** NOUN NEUTRAL	अखंड विशाल इकाई / एकाश्म A large, uniform, and indivisible entity that lacks internal diversity or variation.	'Mono' (single) + 'lith' (stone) = a massive single stone with no internal diversity.	· homogenous entity · bloc · solid mass	· heterogeneous group · diverse entity · plurality
02	**antediluvian** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अति प्राचीन / दकियानूसी Belonging to the time before the biblical Flood; hopelessly old-fashioned or primitive.	'Ante' (before) + 'diluvium' (great biblical flood) = so old it belongs before Noah's flood.	· archaic · obsolete · outmoded	· modern · contemporary · progressive

FIXED PREPOSITIONS 6 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**intrude into** VERB NEGATIVE	अनधिकार प्रवेश करना / दखल देना To enter or force oneself into a private space or matter without invitation.	'In-trude' sounds like 'in-rude'—rudely entering without permission.	· encroach upon · infringe on · trespass into	· respect · withdraw from · abstain from
02	**caution against** VERB NEUTRAL	आगाह करना / सचेत करना To advise or warn someone not to do something or to be wary of a risk.	Showing a caution sign 'against' danger.	· warn against · admonish against · discourage from	· encourage · advocate · endorse
03	**conform to** VERB NEUTRAL	के अनुरूप होना / पालन करना To comply with or follow accepted standards, rules, or laws.	'Con-form' = create according to the specified 'form' or rule.	· comply with · adhere to · abide by	· flout · defy · contravene
04	**enshrined in** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	प्रतिष्ठापित / समाहित होना Formally preserved or protected in a sacred, legal, or constitutional text.	Preserved safely in a holy 'shrine' where it cannot be violated.	· embodied in · incorporated in · safeguarded in	· excluded from · erased from · omitted from
05	**confer on** VERB NEUTRAL	प्रदान करना / प्रदान किया जाना To grant or bestow a right, title, honour, or benefit upon someone.	A degree is 'conferred on' a graduate at a university conference.	· bestow on · grant to · vest in	· strip of · withhold from · deprive of
06	**awash with** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	से भरा हुआ / लबालब Containing large amounts or numbers of something; flooded or inundated.	A wave washes over everything, leaving the place 'awash' or submerged in water.	· inundated with · overflowing with · brimming with	· bereft of · devoid of · lacking in

PHRASAL VERBS 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**strikes at** VERB NEGATIVE	सीधा प्रहार करना / मूल पर चोट करना Attacks, challenges, or threatens the core basis of something.	Imagine a strike hitting the very root of an issue.	· undermines · assails · targets	· bolsters · protects · reinforces

IDIOMS & PHRASES 3 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**holds no weight** PHRASE NEGATIVE	महत्वहीन होना / कोई दम न होना Lacks validity, seriousness, authority, or convincing power.	If an argument lacks 'weight', it easily blows away like paper.	· carries no conviction · is baseless · lacks merit	· carries weight · holds water · is compelling
02	**at variance with** PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE NEGATIVE	से भिन्न या असहमत / के विपरीत In direct conflict, discrepancy, or disagreement with something.	'Variance' means variation or clash; not matching up.	· incompatible with · in conflict with · contrary to	· in harmony with · consistent with · in accord with
03	**open to challenge** PHRASE NEGATIVE	चुनौती के दायरे में / विवाद योग्य Vulnerable to being questioned, contested, or legally and morally opposed.	Leaving the gate 'open' for an opponent to enter and fight.	· disputable · contestable · vulnerable	· indisputable · unassailable · settled

FOREIGN WORDS 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**redux** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	पुनरुत्थान / दोबारा लौटा हुआ Brought back, restored, or revived (used postpositively).	Redux sounds like 're-do'—something brought back or returning again.	· resurgent · revisited · reborn	· extinct · abandoned · departed

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 06
Many layers: On onion produce, issues →

THE HINDU • AGRICULTURAL ECONOMICS & TRADE POLICY

Many layers: On onion produce, issues

Ad hoc policy interventions and poor storage infrastructure fail to resolve recurring onion price volatility.

September 3, 2026 • 2 min read • DAILY EDITORIAL READER

While the government has **alluded to**[12] some price manipulation, the dominant issue remains that it keeps reacting instead of taking **proactive**[13] measures, including improving storage options, maintaining a less **erratic**[6] trade policy, moving stock more efficiently between regions, and protecting farmers against price shocks. The abnormal rainfall at the time of harvest and a 5%-7% drop in the kharif crop in Maharashtra, together with the well-known challenges **associated with**[14] storing onions and maintaining large **buffers**[15], are simply among the pressures that highlighted the flaw this year. Further, Tamil Nadu's targeted subsidy, to buy 1,000 tonnes of onions to distribute 1 kg per ration card at ₹35, will impose pressures on the Centre to maintain a steady supply. The move is **commendably**[16] designed to discourage **hoarding**[17] while allowing private retail prices to **cool down**[18]. However, the State must also **guard against**[19] the **pitfalls**[20] of distributing onions through a dry-grain PDS network — its economic case could collapse if post-harvest losses, to which onion is more **susceptible**[21] than, say, wheat or rice, exceed 10%-15% — and if the need arises to **persist with**[22] the subsidy. Finally, if other States also adopt similar measures, the Central buffer could be quickly **exhausted**[23], more so given this year's high storage losses of around 30%.

Source: The Hindu
Published: September 03, 2026 12:10 AM IST

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **balancing-act** (Noun) compromise • संतुलन साधने का प्रयास
2. **remunerative** (Adjective) profitable • लाभकारी / फलप्रद
3. **volatility** (Noun) instability • अस्थिरता
4. **imposed** (Verb) enforced • थोपा / लागू किया
5. **abolished** (Verb) cancelled • समाप्त कर दिया
6. **erratic** (Adjective) unpredictable • अनियमित / अनिश्चित
7. **rendered** (Verb) made • बना दिया / कर दिया
8. **changes its mind** (Phrase) switches decision • अपना इरादा बदलना
9. **bounteous** (Adjective) plentiful • प्रचुर / भरपूर
10. **procurement** (Noun) purchasing • खरीद / अधिप्राप्ति
11. **subsequently** (Adverb) afterwards • बाद में / तत्पश्चात
12. **alluded to** (Verb) hinted at • का संकेत दिया
13. **proactive** (Adjective) forward-thinking • सक्रिय / अग्रसक्रिय
14. **associated with** (Adjective) linked to • से जुड़ा हुआ
15. **buffers** (Noun) reserves • आकस्मिक भंडार / सुरक्षात्मक भंडार
16. **commendably** (Adverb) praiseworthily • सराहनीय रूप से
17. **hoarding** (Noun) stockpiling • जमाखोरी
18. **cool down** (Verb) moderate • शांत होना / कम होना
19. **guard against** (Verb) prevent • से बचाव करना / सचेत रहना
20. **pitfalls** (Noun) hidden dangers • छिपे हुए खतरे / कमियां
21. **susceptible** (Adjective) vulnerable • संवेदनशील / अतिसंवेदनशील
22. **persist with** (Verb) continue with • जारी रखना
23. **exhausted** (Verb) depleted • पूरी तरह समाप्त

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Many layers: On onion produce, issues
THE HINDU • AGRICULTURAL ECONOMICS & TRADE POLICY

EDITORIAL STANCE
CRITICAL
"fault-finding and cautionary"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author adopts a critical and cautionary tone to scrutinise the government's recurring, short-term interventions in onion trade and pricing. By pointing out erratic export duties, inadequate storage infrastructure, and severe post-harvest losses, the editorial demonstrates how reactive policies destabilise farm incomes and market supplies. It ultimately urges policymakers to shift away from ad-hoc measures towards structural, proactive supply-chain solutions.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY 13 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**remunerative** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	लाभकारी / फलप्रद Yielding suitable or generous financial reward or profit.	Sounds like 're-money-rative' — getting good money or return for your work.	· lucrative · profitable · gainful	· unprofitable · unremunerative · loss-making
02	**volatility** NOUN NEGATIVE	अस्थिरता Liability to change rapidly and unpredictably, especially for the worse.	Think of 'volatile' liquids like petrol that evaporate quickly and unpredictably.	· instability · unpredictability · fluctuation	· stability · constancy · steadiness
03	**imposed** VERB NEGATIVE	थोपा / लागू किया Forced an unwelcome rule, tax, or restriction to be accepted or put in place.	Break it into 'im-pose' — when someone poses a heavy burden or rule upon you.	· enforced · levied · instituted	· lifted · revoked · repealed
04	**erratic** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनियमित / अनिश्चित Not even or regular in pattern or movement; wildly unpredictable.	Relate 'erratic' to 'error' — behaving with errors and having no fixed pattern.	· inconsistent · irregular · fitful	· consistent · predictable · steady
05	**rendered** VERB NEUTRAL	बना दिया / कर दिया Caused someone or something to become or be in a specified condition.	Computer graphics 'render' code into an image; in English, an event 'renders' something into a specific state.	· caused to become · made · turned	· retained · preserved · kept
06	**bounteous** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	प्रचुर / भरपूर Generously given or existing in abundant and plentiful quantities.	Connect with 'bounty' or 'bonus' — receiving plenty of good things in large quantity.	· abundant · plentiful · copious	· scarce · meagre · scant
07	**subsequently** ADVERB NEUTRAL	बाद में / तत्पश्चात At a later time or after something else has occurred.	Prefix 'sub-' and root 'sequence' — following in sequence after an initial event.	· afterwards · thereafter · consequently	· previously · priorly · beforehand
08	**proactive** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	सक्रिय / अग्रसक्रिय Creating or controlling a situation rather than just responding after it has happened.	'Pro' (in advance) + 'active' — taking action before a crisis happens, not just reacting.	· pre-emptive · enterprising · preventative	· reactive · passive · sluggish
09	**buffers** NOUN POSITIVE	आकस्मिक भंडार / सुरक्षात्मक भंडार Reserve stocks of commodities held to offset future shortages or price instability.	A buffer cushions a blow; a buffer stock cushions against shortages and sudden price surges.	· cushions · stockpiles · safeguards	· deficits · shortages · exhaustions
10	**commendably** ADVERB POSITIVE	सराहनीय रूप से In a manner that deserves high praise, approval, or commendation.	Think of leaving a good 'comment' or giving a medal to 'commend' good work.	· admirably · laudably · creditably	· deplorably · disgracefully · shamefully
11	**pitfalls** NOUN NEGATIVE	छिपे हुए खतरे / कमियां Hidden or unsuspected dangers, difficulties, or traps in a plan or scheme.	A hidden 'pit' in the ground in which you 'fall' without expecting it.	· hazards · snags · perils	· benefits · advantages · safeguards
12	**susceptible** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	संवेदनशील / अतिसंवेदनशील Likely or liable to be influenced, harmed, or affected by a particular thing.	Sounds like 'suspicious of infection' — someone with weak immunity is easily affected.	· vulnerable · prone · liable	· immune · resistant · impervious
13	**exhausted** VERB NEGATIVE	पूरी तरह समाप्त Used up completely so that none of the supply or energy remains.	Car 'exhaust' releases smoke until the fuel tank is completely empty and exhausted.	· depleted · drained · consumed	· replenished · restored · augmented

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • MANY LAYERS: ON ONION PRODUCE, ISSUES

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS 3 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**abolished** VERB POSITIVE	समाप्त कर दिया Formally put an end to a system, practice, or official duty.	'A-polish' completely rubs off the old layer; similarly, 'abolish' completely rubs out an old law.	· scrapped · annulled · nullified	· established · introduced · enacted
02	**procurement** NOUN NEUTRAL	खरीद / अधिप्राप्ति The official act of obtaining or buying goods and services, especially for public use.	Think of 'pro-cure' -> actively seeking to secure or purchase necessary supplies.	· acquisition · purchasing · requisition	· sale · disposal · divestment
03	**hoarding** NOUN NEGATIVE	जमाखोरी The practice of accumulating and storing large quantities of items to create artificial scarcity.	A 'horde' is a large hidden crowd; 'hoarding' is secretly hiding large quantities of goods for profit.	· stockpiling · accumulating · amassing	· distributing · dispersing · releasing

FIXED PREPOSITIONS 3 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**alluded to** VERB NEUTRAL	का संकेत दिया Suggested or called attention to something indirectly rather than stating it plainly.	'Allude' sounds like an 'illusion' — you don't show the full picture, you just hint at it.	· hinted at · insinuated · referred to	· stated directly · specified · declared openly
02	**associated with** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	से जुड़ा हुआ Connected with something else in thought, relation, or consequence.	'Associate' means a colleague or partner; things 'associated with' always go together.	· connected with · related to · linked to	· unconnected with · detached from · independent of
03	**persist with** VERB NEUTRAL	जारी रखना To continue firmly in an opinion, scheme, or course of action despite difficulty or opposition.	'Per-sister' keeps knocking the door until opened; 'persist' means sticking to an action continuously.	· persevere with · carry on with · continue with	· abandon · discontinue · desist from

PHRASAL VERBS 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**cool down** VERB POSITIVE	शांत होना / कम होना To become calmer, less intense, or reduced in price and level.	Hot prices burning pockets need to 'cool down' to become comfortable and affordable.	· subside · ease · abate	· escalate · flare up · surge
02	**guard against** VERB NEUTRAL	से बचाव करना / सचेत रहना To take precautions in order to avoid or stop something dangerous or unpleasant happening.	Stand like a security 'guard' at the door to keep danger 'against' entering.	· shield against · fend off · ward off	· succumb to · invite · neglect

IDIOMS & PHRASES 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**balancing-act** NOUN NEUTRAL	संतुलन साधने का प्रयास A difficult situation in which one tries to satisfy two or more opposing demands at the same time.	Imagine an acrobat walking on a tightrope trying to maintain balance between two opposing sides.	· tightrope walk · compromise · delicate equilibrium	· imbalance · one-sidedness · disproportion
02	**changes its mind** PHRASE NEGATIVE	अपना इरादा बदलना Alters one's opinion, intention, or decision regarding a course of action.	Literally swapping out one thought or decision for another after already deciding.	· reconsiders · vacillates · backtracks	· stands firm · perseveres · remains resolute

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 09
Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there's a question →

THE INDIAN EXPRESS • JUDICIAL REFORM & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there's a question

Selective quashing of protest FIRs exposes systemic bias in state response to democratic dissent.

September 3, 2026 • 3 min read • DAILY EDITORIAL READER

All the FIRs ... are hereby **quashed**[1]." With that order by a three-judge bench, led by Chief justice of India Surya Kant, a welcome moment of closure was reached on Tuesday. The story began with the students' protests at Jantar Mantar against the NEET paper leak. It saw a **brutish**[2] **crackdown**[3] by the police on the march by mostly young protesters demanding a hearing from the people's representatives in Parliament. These columns have strongly and consistently argued for the freedom to protest peacefully, which is part of the constitutionally guaranteed right to free speech and expression, and against its **criminalisation**[4] by the government. And yet, **rewind to**[5] Tuesday's quashing of FIRs by the Court, acting on the request of governments at the Centre and some states, and a question continues to hang in the courtroom: If Tuesday's quashing is an admission that a punishing state unfairly targeted citizens for exercising their democratic right to protest, isn't the manner of the quashing problematic — because it seems selective? The cases being closed is the right thing to do, but are they being closed for the right reason? Does the government find it **expedient**[6] to close them against one set of protesters while letting those against other protesters **linger on**[7], making the process their punishment? The question is, basically, this: What about the protesters **left out**[8] of Tuesday's frame?

Because the story of the April protests by factory workers in Noida demanding higher wages has **played out**[9] very differently. There, as this paper has reported, a police **crackdown**[3] saw up to 200 people taken into custody, including two under the **stringent**[10] NSA. The court **stepped in**[11] to grant relief in 84 per cent of the cases — on Wednesday, the Allahabad High Court **quashed**[1] the NSA detention of a student activist, terming the state's case "**concocted**[12]". But they fell one by one, for reasons ranging from lack of specific evidence to treating a crowd as the accused. There was no **blanket**[13] relief — the average period a protester spent in custody was 53 days. Cases related to the 2019-2020 protests against a **discriminatory**[14] citizenship law **unleashed**[15] **prolonged**[16] legal battles across various courts. In UP, the government continued to harass the accused, naming and shaming them in public hoardings, attaching properties by **undue**[17] process, ignoring the court's **rebuke**[18] that it had become both complainant and **adjudicator**[19]. Cases from the farmers' protests of 2021 are still pending. As are those **slapped against**[20] individuals across the country, for the "crime" of disagreeing with the **powers that be**[21].

Tuesday's quashing of FIRs against students will be a valuable moment if it expands the area of freedom for all — if it means that **henceforth**[22], the government will be more tolerant of free speech and the Court will give the **benefit of the doubt**[23] to the vulnerable individual, not the government. It will be unfortunate if it only means that the decision to file an FIR and the decision to quash a protest depends on whether the protester is seen as "us" or "them".

Source: The Indian Express
Published: September 03, 2026 06:00 AM IST

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **Quashed** (Verb) Cancelled • रद्द किया
2. **Brutish** (Adjective) Savage • पाशविक / क्रूर
3. **Crackdown** (Noun) Suppression • कड़ी कार्रवाई
4. **Criminalisation** (Noun) Outlawing • अपराधीकरण
5. **Rewind to** (Verb phrase) Look back at • पिछली घटना पर लौटना
6. **Expedient** (Adjective) Convenient • स्वार्थपूर्ण / व्यावहारिक
7. **Linger on** (Verb phrase) Drag on • लम्बा खिंचना
8. **Left out** (Verb phrase) Excluded • वंचित / बाहर रखा गया
9. **Played out** (Verb phrase) Unfolded • घटित होना
10. **Stringent** (Adjective) Strict • कठोर
11. **Stepped in** (Verb phrase) Intervened • हस्तक्षेप किया
12. **Concocted** (Adjective) Fabricated • मनगढ़ंत
13. **Blanket** (Adjective) Comprehensive • व्यापक / सार्वत्रिक
14. **Discriminatory** (Adjective) Biased • भेदभावपूर्ण
15. **Unleashed** (Verb) Triggered • खुला छोड़ दिया / भड़काया
16. **Prolonged** (Adjective) Extended • दीर्घकालीन
17. **Undue** (Adjective) Improper • अनुचित
18. **Rebuke** (Noun) Reprimand • फटकार
19. **Adjudicator** (Noun) Judge • अधिनिर्णायक
20. **Slapped against** (Prepositional phrase) Imposed upon • थोपना (मुकदमा/आरोप)
21. **Powers that be** (Noun phrase) Authorities • सत्ताधारी
22. **Henceforth** (Adverb) From now on • अब से
23. **Benefit of the doubt** (Noun phrase) Favourable assumption • संदेह का लाभ

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there's a question
THE INDIAN EXPRESS • JUDICIAL REFORM & CIVIL LIBERTIES

EDITORIAL STANCE
SCEPTICAL
"questioning selective justice"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author welcomes the Supreme Court's quashing of FIRs against student demonstrators while critically questioning the selective benevolence shown by the state. By contrasting this sudden relief with the protracted harassment faced by Noida factory workers and anti-citizenship law protesters, the piece highlights how legal relief is politicised. It ultimately warns that true judicial protection must apply uniformly to all citizens rather than serving the expedient interests of those in power.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY 13 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Quashed** VERB POSITIVE	रद्द किया Officially rejected, nullified, or declared legally void by a court.	Sounds like 'squashed'—the court squashed and crushed the legal charges completely.	· annulled · nullified · rescinded	· validated · upheld · ratified
02	**Brutish** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	पाशविक / क्रूर Extremely cruel, rough, or unfeeling in manner or action.	Relate it to 'brute'—behaving like a wild beast without reason or mercy.	· barbaric · ruthless · ferocious	· humane · gentle · compassionate
03	**Criminalisation** NOUN NEGATIVE	अपराधीकरण The act of turning a previously lawful activity or right into an illegal criminal offence.	Root word 'criminal'—turning a peaceful democratic action into a punishable crime.	· proscription · banning · penalisation	· decriminalisation · legalisation · authorisation
04	**Expedient** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	स्वार्थपूर्ण / व्यावहारिक Convenient and practical for achieving an immediate end, though possibly improper or immoral.	'Ex-speed-ient'—doing what is speedy and beneficial for oneself regardless of fairness.	· opportunistic · self-serving · advantageous	· unprincipled · inexpedient · disadvantageous
05	**Stringent** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	कठोर Demanding strict attention to rules and leaving very little room for discretion.	Connect to 'stringent' and 'strict'—drawing tight strings that restrict movement.	· rigorous · exacting · inflexible	· lenient · flexible · lax
06	**Concocted** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	मनगढ़ंत Fabricated or invented, especially in an attempt to deceive.	Like 'concocting' an artificial chemical drink—mixing up false ingredients to make a fake story.	· fabricated · trumped-up · manufactured	· authentic · genuine · factual
07	**Blanket** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	व्यापक / सार्वत्रिक Applying to all conditions, instances, or people without exception.	A blanket spreads over and covers everything beneath it entirely.	· all-encompassing · sweeping · universal	· selective · partial · conditional
08	**Discriminatory** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	भेदभावपूर्ण Characterised by unjust or prejudicial treatment of different categories of people.	Root word 'discriminate'—unfairly making distinctions against a particular group.	· prejudicial · inequitable · partisan	· equitable · impartial · unbiased
09	**Unleashed** VERB NEGATIVE	खुला छोड़ दिया / भड़काया Suddenly released or set free a powerful or destructive force.	Un-leash: removing the leash from a violent animal to let it loose.	· precipitated · unloosed · released	· restrained · suppressed · curbed
10	**Prolonged** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	दीर्घकालीन Continuing for a long or excessive period, often causing hardship.	Pro + long: intentionally made or drawn out for a long time.	· protracted · extended · lengthened	· brief · fleeting · transitory
11	**Undue** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनुचित Exceeding what is appropriate, warranted, or legally standard.	Un- (not) + due (appropriate/rightful) = not legally or morally justified.	· unwarranted · disproportionate · unjustified	· due · warranted · appropriate
12	**Rebuke** NOUN NEGATIVE	फटकार A sharp, official expression of severe criticism and disapproval.	Sounds like 'rebuff'—strongly pushing back against misconduct with stern words.	· censure · reproach · admonition	· commendation · praise · endorsement
13	**Henceforth** ADVERB NEUTRAL	अब से From this particular point in time forward.	'Hence' (from here) + 'forth' (going forward into the future).	· hereafter · henceforward · subsequently	· theretofore · previously · formerly

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • THANK YOU FOR QUASHING THE FIRS, BUT THERE'S A QUESTION

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Crackdown** NOUN NEGATIVE	कड़ी कार्रवाई Severe, sudden, and strict enforcement of rules or laws against people.	Police 'cracking' down their batons to forcefully halt public defiance.	· suppression · clampdown · repression	· relaxation · leniency · indulgence
02	**Adjudicator** NOUN NEUTRAL	अधिनिर्णायक A person or body that formally pronounces a judgment or resolves a legal dispute.	Contains 'jud' as in judge—a person formalised to deliver a legal verdict.	· arbiter · referee · judge	· litigant · complainant · disputant

FIXED PREPOSITIONS 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Slapped against** PREPOSITIONAL PHRASE NEGATIVE	थोपना (मुकदमा/आरोप) Arbitrarily, swiftly, or harshly levied or filed against an individual.	Like a harsh physical 'slap' hitting 'against' someone suddenly and forcefully.	· levied on · foisted upon · thrust upon	· withdrawn from · lifted from · waived for

PHRASAL VERBS 5 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Rewind to** VERB PHRASE NEUTRAL	पिछली घटना पर लौटना To return to or reconsider an earlier event or point in time.	Like 'rewinding' a video tape back to review an earlier scene.	· revisit · hark back to · recall	· fast-forward · advance · proceed
02	**Linger on** VERB PHRASE NEGATIVE	लम्बा खिंचना To continue to exist or drag out for longer than is normal or desirable.	Think of 'longer'—persisting for far longer than necessary.	· persist · protract · continue	· cease · terminate · vanish
03	**Left out** VERB PHRASE NEGATIVE	वंचित / बाहर रखा गया Not included in an arrangement, benefit, or consideration.	Being left 'out' in the cold while others are invited inside for relief.	· omitted · excluded · overlooked	· included · incorporated · embraced
04	**Played out** VERB PHRASE NEUTRAL	घटित होना Developed, progressed, or reached a conclusion in a specific manner.	Like a theatrical play unfolding from beginning to end on stage.	· transpired · developed · occurred	· halted · stalled · frozen
05	**Stepped in** VERB PHRASE POSITIVE	हस्तक्षेप किया Became involved in an unpleasant situation to help, arbitrate, or prevent harm.	Physically 'stepping in' between two people to stop an unfair fight.	· interceded · intervened · mediated	· withdrew · ignored · abstained

IDIOMS & PHRASES 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**Powers that be** NOUN PHRASE NEUTRAL	सत्ताधारी The established authorities or ruling elite who wield administrative and political power.	The established 'powers' that currently exist ('be') in governance.	· establishment · ruling classes · regime	· commoners · masses · populace
02	**Benefit of the doubt** NOUN PHRASE POSITIVE	संदेह का लाभ A concession that an accused person is innocent or right when evidence is not definitive.	Giving someone the 'benefit' of trust whenever evidence is unclear or doubtful.	· favourable interpretation · presumption of innocence · grace	· suspicion · presumption of guilt · scepticism

READ NEXT EDITORIAL • PAGE 12
Cauvery needs a distress-sharing compact →

THE INDIAN EXPRESS • INTER-STATE WATER DISPUTE & RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

Cauvery needs a distress-sharing compact

Riparian states must abandon confrontation and collaborate on distress-sharing mechanisms for sustainable water management.

September 3, 2026 • 2 min read • DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The opening of the Mettur Dam's **sluice gates**[1] by Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Tuesday will provide some relief to Cauvery Delta farmers. In a normal year, the dam opens on June 12, and its gates are shut on January 28, giving the region's agriculturists a 230-day irrigation window. This schedule is, however, **contingent on**[2] the monsoon and the release of water in the Cauvery's **upstream**[3] by Karnataka. The Tamil Nadu government has **ascribed**[4] this year's delay to the **deficit**[5] in the southwest monsoon and Karnataka's failure to honour its water-sharing obligation under the Supreme Court's 2018 verdict. The dispute between the lower and upper **riparian**[6] states **ignited**[7] political tensions in the past three months, and the matter went to the Supreme Court, but the **impasse**[8] wasn't resolved. With the rainfall **deficit**[5] narrowing in August, the Tamil Nadu government has **leeway**[9] to release water for 45 days.

The Cauvery Management Authority, set up to **oversee**[10] the implementation of the 2018 verdict, has worked during normal monsoon years. But the Court did not **codify**[11] a formula for water-sharing in years when the rains **play truant**[12]. Its emphasis on sustainable water use was lost on the two states, and the dispute **flared up**[13] again in 2023 — the first **below-par**[14] monsoon after 2018.

The Tamil Nadu government has said that it will continue legal efforts to secure its share of the Cauvery's waters. Karnataka's push for the Mekedatu Dam on the river has **reignited**[15] old fears . The D K Shivakumar government's argument that the dam would primarily serve Bengaluru's water needs while allowing better regulation of releases hasn't **found any takers**[16] in Tamil Nadu. The fact is, the Cauvery today has to meet the **competing demands**[17] of agriculture and urbanisation. Therefore, rather than **lean on**[18] the judiciary, Cauvery-dependent states **would do well to**[19] come together and plan for the efficient use of the river's waters. Solutions ranging from **disincentivising**[20] **water-intensive**[21] crops to encouraging **decentralised**[22] water management will require inputs of hydrologists, economists, agri-scientists and farmers' organisations. Representatives of the two states will need to sit together, understand each other's fears and shed **confrontationist**[23] attitudes.

Source: The Indian Express
Published: September 03, 2026 06:05 AM IST

★ VOCABULARY 101

1. **sluice gates** (Noun) water gates • जलद्वार
2. **contingent on** (Adjective) dependent on • पर निर्भर
3. **upstream** (Noun) river source region • उर्ध्वप्रवाह
4. **ascribed** (Verb) attributed • श्रेय देना या कारण बताना
5. **deficit** (Noun) shortfall • कमी या घाटा
6. **riparian** (Adjective) riverbank-related • तटवर्ती या नदी-किनारे का
7. **ignited** (Verb) sparked • भड़काया
8. **impasse** (Noun) deadlock • गतिरोध
9. **leeway** (Noun) room to maneuver • कार्य करने की छूट
10. **oversee** (Verb) supervise • निगरानी करना
11. **codify** (Verb) systematise • नियमबद्ध करना
12. **play truant** (Verb) stay absent • अनुपस्थित रहना
13. **flared up** (Verb) erupted suddenly • अचानक भड़क उठना
14. **below-par** (Adjective) substandard • सामान्य से कम
15. **reignited** (Verb) revived • पुनः भड़काना
16. **found any takers** (Verb) gained acceptance • स्वीकार करने वाला मिलना
17. **competing demands** (Noun) conflicting claims • आपसी परस्पर विरोधी मांगें
18. **lean on** (Verb) depend heavily on • निर्भर रहना या सहारा लेना
19. **would do well to** (Phrase) ought to • उचित रहेगा कि
20. **disincentivising** (Verb) discouraging • हतोत्साहित करना
21. **water-intensive** (Adjective) water-heavy • अत्यधिक जल की खपत वाला
22. **decentralised** (Adjective) localised • विकेंद्रीकृत
23. **confrontationist** (Adjective) aggressive • टकरावादी

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EDITORIAL ANALYSIS & VOCABULARY LAB

ARTICLE: Cauvery needs a distress-sharing compact
THE INDIAN EXPRESS • INTER-STATE WATER DISPUTE & RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

EDITORIAL STANCE
PERSUASIVE / ADVOCATIVE
"urging cooperative policy solutions"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE
The author adopts a persuasive and pragmatic tone to highlight the recurring governance failure between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka during deficient monsoons. Pointing out that neither judicial verdicts nor unilateral infrastructure projects have resolved the deadlock, the editorial urges both states to move past confrontation. It advocates institutionalised distress-sharing formulas and multi-disciplinary reforms in agricultural and water management.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY 13 WORDS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**sluice gates** NOUN NEUTRAL	जलद्वार Sliding barrier mechanisms used to control or regulate the flow of water in a dam or canal.	Think of 'slide' + 'juice/water': gates that slide open to let accumulated water rush out.	· floodgates · watergates · headgates	· barriers · blockades · plugs
02	**upstream** NOUN NEUTRAL	उर्ध्वप्रवाह The upper section of a river closer to its source, situated higher against the direction of flow.	Up + stream: moving up towards the origin of a stream or river.	· headwaters · upper reaches · riverhead	· downstream · river mouth · estuary
03	**ascribed** VERB NEUTRAL	श्रेय देना या कारण बताना Regarded something as being caused by or belonging to a specific factor.	Relate 'ascribe' to 'describe the cause': assigning a reason to an event.	· attributed · assigned · imputed	· disconnected · dissociated · discredited
04	**deficit** NOUN NEGATIVE	कमी या घाटा The amount by which an aggregate quantity falls short of the required or expected mark.	Connect 'deficit' with 'deficient'—signifying an amount below the expected level.	· shortfall · deficiency · shortage	· surplus · excess · abundance
05	**ignited** VERB NEGATIVE	भड़काया Aroused, triggered, or provoked sudden and intense conflict or emotion.	Like ignition in a car that creates a spark, it means sparking intense emotions or tensions.	· sparked · triggered · instigated	· doused · quelled · extinguished
06	**leeway** NOUN POSITIVE	कार्य करने की छूट The amount of freedom to move, act, or make changes within defined boundaries.	Giving someone 'free way' or 'liberty' provides them leeway to act flexibly.	· latitude · elbow room · flexibility	· constraint · restriction · limitation
07	**oversee** VERB NEUTRAL	निगरानी करना To supervise or monitor a process or policy to ensure it is carried out correctly.	Over + see: to look over something from above to make sure it is functioning properly.	· supervise · monitor · administer	· neglect · ignore · overlook
08	**codify** VERB NEUTRAL	नियमबद्ध करना To arrange laws, rules, or formulas into a formal, systematic written code.	Turning scattered ideas into a written 'code' or rulebook.	· systematise · formalise · standardise	· disorganise · scramble · jumble
09	**reignited** VERB NEGATIVE	पुनः भड़काना Revived or triggered something dormant, such as hostility, fear, or conflict.	Re (again) + ignite (spark): sparking an old flame or controversy all over again.	· rekindled · resurrected · re-energised	· quenched · dampened · suppressed
10	**disincentivising** VERB NEUTRAL	हतोत्साहित करना Discouraging a particular behaviour or activity by removing benefits or adding deterrents.	Dis (remove) + incentive: taking away the reward so people stop doing something.	· discouraging · deterring · dissuading	· incentivising · encouraging · promoting
11	**water-intensive** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	अत्यधिक जल की खपत वाला Requiring very large quantities of water to grow, produce, or maintain.	Water + intense: processes that require intense or massive amounts of water.	· water-demanding · water-guzzling · high-water-use	· drought-resistant · water-efficient · arid-tolerant
12	**decentralised** ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	विकेंद्रीकृत Distributed or controlled by several local authorities rather than one central body.	De-central: moving authority and operational management away from a single central point.	· localised · dispersed · distributed	· centralised · concentrated · consolidated
13	**confrontationist** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	टकरावादी Tending to instigate, provoke, or engage in hostile disputes and arguments.	Root word 'confront'—someone who prefers facing off in conflict rather than settling peacefully.	· belligerent · combative · adversarial	· conciliatory · cooperative · accommodating

VOCAB LAB CONTINUED • CAUVERY NEEDS A DISTRESS-SHARING COMPACT

PART 02

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**riparian** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	तटवर्ती या नदी-किनारे का Relating to or situated along the banks of a natural watercourse or river.	Sounds like 'river pairs': states paired along the banks of the same river.	· riverine · waterside · bankside	· landlocked · arid · inland
02	**impasse** NOUN NEGATIVE	गतिरोध A situation in which no progress is possible, especially because of a disagreement.	'Impossible to pass' through a road leads to an impasse (deadlock).	· deadlock · stalemate · standstill	· breakthrough · resolution · headway

FIXED PREPOSITIONS 1 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**contingent on** ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	पर निर्भर Subject to or determined by certain prior conditions or circumstances.	Sound like 'continue if agent acts': an action that continues only if a condition is met.	· conditional upon · dependent on · hinging upon	· independent of · unconditional · irrespective of

PHRASAL VERBS 2 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**flared up** VERB NEGATIVE	अचानक भड़क उठना Suddenly burst into intense activity, violence, or aggressive debate.	Like a fire 'flaring' into high flames, an argument suddenly grows fierce.	· erupted · reignited · exploded	· subsided · abated · died down
02	**lean on** VERB NEUTRAL	निर्भर रहना या सहारा लेना To depend excessively upon someone or an institution for support or a resolution.	Literally 'leaning' against a wall for support—relying excessively on an external pillar.	· rely on · bank on · fall back on	· stand independently · disavow · shun

IDIOMS & PHRASES 5 TERMS

			MEMORY HOOK	SYNONYMS	ANTONYMS
01	**play truant** VERB NEGATIVE	अनुपस्थित रहना To stay away or fail to appear when expected; to be elusive or deficient.	Refers to a student skipping school; here used for rains that fail to arrive as expected.	· absent oneself · fail to show · skive	· appear reliably · show up · materialise
02	**below-par** ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	सामान्य से कम Lower than the usual, expected, or satisfactory standard or average.	In golf, 'par' is standard; being 'below-par' contextually means failing to meet normal levels.	· substandard · deficient · inferior	· above-par · superior · exemplary
03	**found any takers** VERB NEGATIVE	स्वीकार करने वाला मिलना Found willing buyers, believers, or supporters for an offer or argument.	A 'taker' accepts a deal; having no takers means nobody is buying or believing the pitch.	· gained traction · won acceptance · found buyers	· faced rejection · met cold resistance · been dismissed
04	**competing demands** NOUN NEUTRAL	आपसी परस्पर विरोधी मांगें Rival or conflicting requirements that contest for the exact same limited resource.	Demands that 'compete' for the same limited pool of resources.	· conflicting priorities · rival claims · opposing interests	· aligned interests · harmonious goals · mutual needs
05	**would do well to** PHRASE POSITIVE	उचित रहेगा कि Used to suggest that a specified course of action is sensible, advisable, or beneficial.	A polite, advisory phrase signaling that following this path produces a good outcome.	· ought to · should consider · are advised to	· should avoid · would be unwise to · ought not to

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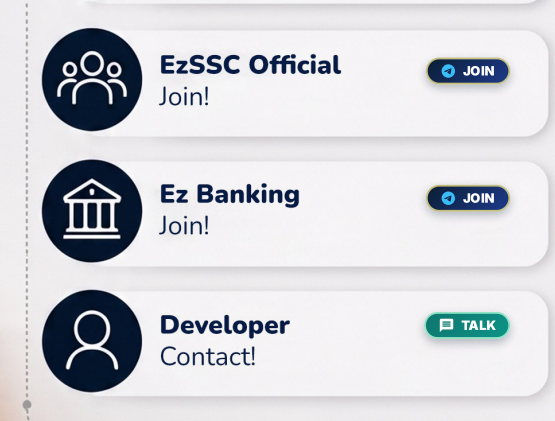
TODAY'S EDITORIALS

ONE STEP AHEAD EVERYDAY ★

📅 SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

THANK YOU!



FOR READING. FOR LEARNING.
FOR GROWING EVERY DAY.

We're really thrilled to keep working on this. We hope you'll continue supporting this effort until the very end. Most importantly, we hope each one of you achieves success and gets selected in your recruitment exam. ❤️📚✨

If you put in the necessary effort and stay consistent, your ambition of building a career in the public or private sector can certainly become a reality.

Just keep in mind one thing,
> ***"A reader lives a thousand lives before he dies... The man who never reads lives only one."***

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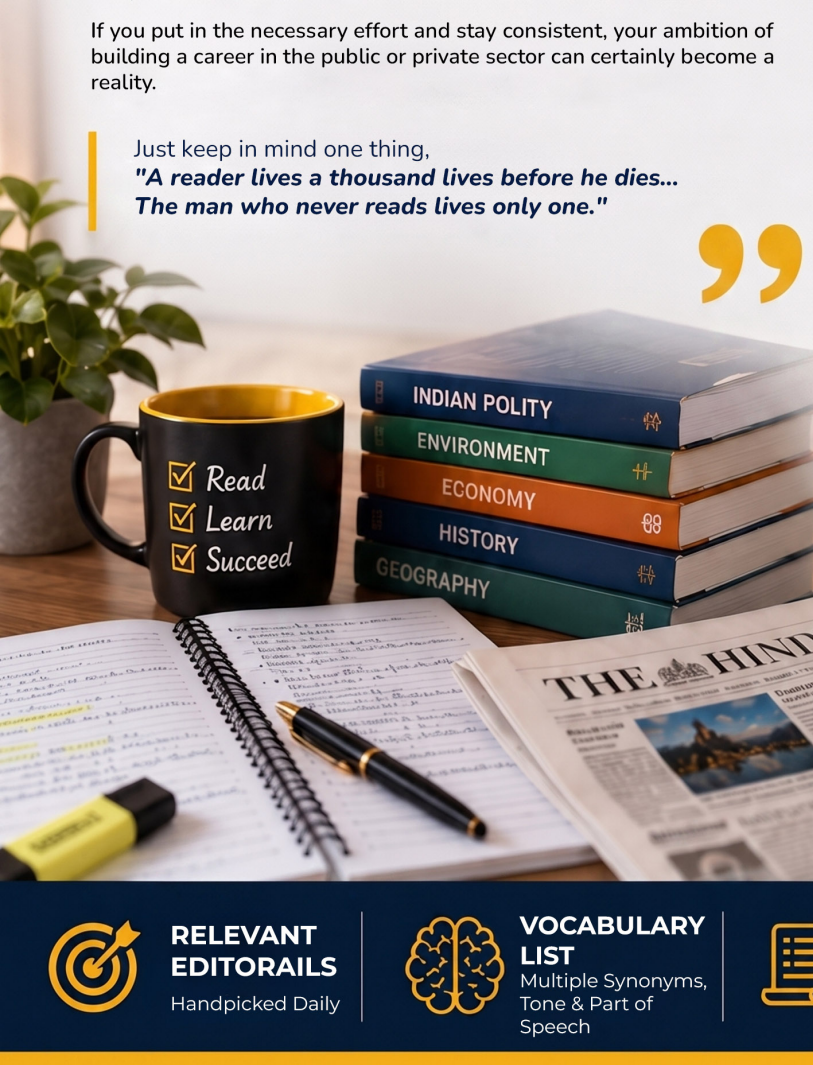

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